Critical Task Milestones — Statement of Work

Sep 30, 2026

Overview

Critical Task Milestones adds a dated, watched checkpoint system to your highest-priority work items, so a critical task is never a single all-or-nothing deadline again. A manager breaks it into up to 4 milestones, each with its own due date and a list of people to alert if it slips. The assignee can request a different date; the manager decides. If a milestone runs late, its watchers get emailed automatically, every day, until it is resolved — no one has to remember to chase it.

Why this is needed

Today a critical task carries one status and one due date. If it is going to run late, nobody finds out until the due date has already passed — there is no earlier checkpoint, and no one is automatically told. The platform's earlier answer to "break a task into pieces," a free-form sub-task checklist, tracked completion but not dates, watchers or approval, so it never surfaced a delay either. This feature replaces that checklist for critical work with something that actually watches the calendar and speaks up before the deadline is missed, not after.

Scope of work

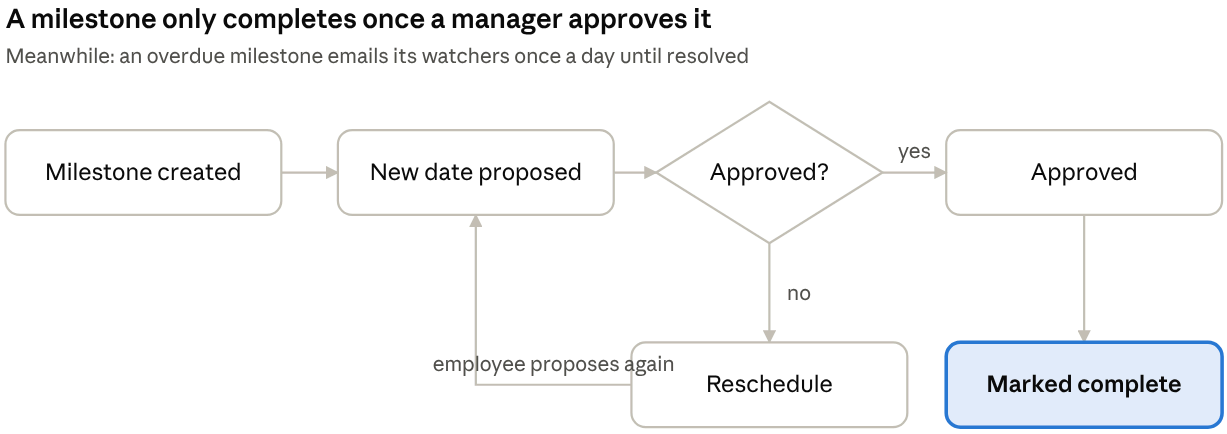
- **Who can use it.** Only a manager (or above) can turn milestone tracking on for a task, and only when that task's priority is set to Critical.
- **Up to 4 milestones per task**, each with its own title and due date. A milestone's due date can never be later than the task's own due date.
- **Watchers.** Each milestone carries a list of email addresses — people to notify if it runs late. A watcher does not need a login to this system.
- **Propose → approve workflow.** The person the task is assigned to can propose a different completion date for a milestone; a manager must approve it before it takes effect. Approving every milestone on a task releases it to start.

- **Daily delay escalation.** Once a day, the system checks for any milestone past its due date and not yet finished, and emails every one of its watchers — automatically, with no manual step — until it is completed or rescheduled.
- **Dashboard visibility.** Anyone with overdue milestones (or their manager, or HR/admin) sees them called out on their dashboard the moment they log in.

Roles & responsibilities

Action	Manager	Employee (task owner)	System
Turn on milestone tracking	Yes, at task creation	—	Rejects it on any non-critical task
Add / edit / remove a milestone	Yes	—	Enforces the 4-milestone cap and the due-date bound
Add watcher emails	Yes	—	—
Propose a new completion date	—	Yes	—
Approve a milestone / a proposed date	Yes	—	Unlocks the task once every milestone is approved
Mark a milestone complete	—	Yes, once approved	—
Escalate an overdue milestone	—	—	Yes — daily email to watchers + dashboard alert

How a milestone moves from created to complete



milestone workflow · propose, approve, complete, with a reschedule loop

A milestone can only be marked complete after a manager has approved it — either as originally set, or at the date the employee proposed.

What's being retired

The existing sub-task checklist — a simple, unwatched, undated list of items under a task — is removed for critical work and replaced by this feature. It held no adoption to date, so nothing is migrated; teams move straight to milestone tracking for any critical task going forward. Non-critical tasks are unaffected — milestone tracking is opt-in and critical-only, everything else works exactly as it does today.

Deliverables

- "Track this task milestone-wise" toggle on the task creation screen (manager+, critical priority only)
- Milestone panel on the task detail view: add, edit, propose a date, approve, mark complete, remove
- Daily automated email escalation to a milestone's watchers while it is overdue
- "Overdue Milestones" card on the team dashboard
- Underlying API endpoints for all of the above, documented in the API reference (Swagger)

Assumptions & dependencies

- A task must already have its own due date before a milestone can be added to it.
- Watcher emails may belong to people outside the platform — they receive escalation emails only, never a dashboard login.
- The daily escalation check runs inside the existing application server; it needs no new infrastructure and no separate job scheduler.
- Milestone tracking can only be turned on when a task is created — it cannot be added to an existing task after the fact.

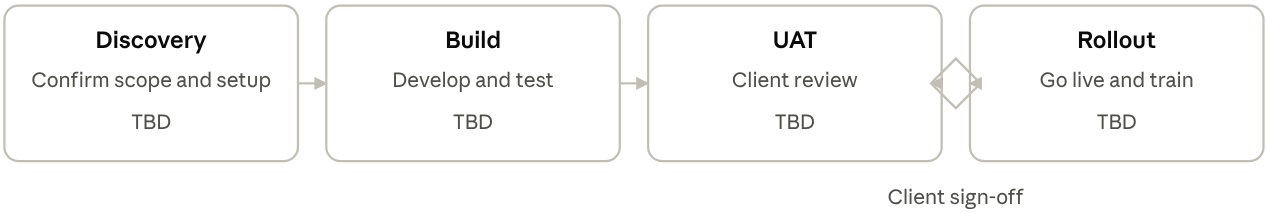
Acceptance criteria

- [ ] A non-manager cannot turn on milestone tracking for a task
- [ ] Milestone tracking cannot be enabled on a non-critical task
- [ ] A 5th milestone on the same task is rejected
- [ ] A milestone due date later than the task's own due date is rejected
- [ ] The task's assignee can propose a new completion date for a milestone
- [ ] Only a manager can approve a milestone or a proposed date
- [ ] A milestone can only be marked complete after it has been approved
- [ ] Approving every milestone on a task releases it to start
- [ ] An overdue, unfinished milestone's watchers receive an escalation email once per day
- [ ] Overdue milestones the current user is entitled to see appear on their dashboard

Indicative timeline

A four-phase rollout, with client sign-off before go-live

Target dates to be confirmed at kickoff — bands are equal width, not to scale



four equal-width phases, dates to be confirmed at kickoff

Bands are shown equal width, not to scale — actual durations and dates depend on the kickoff date and are confirmed once this SOW is signed.

Sign-off

	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by	Biswajit		
Approved by (client)			